Montaque Reynolds

PhD, Philosophy | DeLand, FL | Visiting Assistant Professor, Stetson University

American Philosophical Association · American Society of Aesthetics · Saint Louis Digital Humanities

Education

- PhD, Philosophy — Saint Louis University, Saint Louis, MO *(2024)*
  - Dissertation: Emotional Data and Spiritual Meaning: An analysis of the moral expression of sentiment in fiction.
  - Committee: Helen De Cruz, Dan Haybron, Scott Gelfand, Scott Ragland
- M.A., Philosophy — Oklahoma State University, Stillwater, OK (2017)
  - Thesis: Evolution of Religious Belief and Naturalism: Agency, Character and Adaptation in Christian Belief
  - Advisor: Eric Reitan
- B.A., Philosophy — Seattle Pacific University, Seattle, WA (2015)
- Missions Concentration — Rhema Bible College, Broken Arrow, OK (2010)

Academic Positions

Visiting Assistant Professor of Philosophy — Stetson University, DeLand, FL_(2025–Present)

- Spring 2026: Taught three sections across three courses (87 students total): Value, Meaning, and Humanity's Place in the Modern World (2 sections, 53 students); Introduction to Logic (1 section, 17 students); Philosophy of Law (1 section, 17 students).
- Fall 2025: Taught three sections across two courses (57 students total): Introduction to Philosophy (2 sections, 46 students); Aesthetics (1 section, 11 students).

- Spring 2027: Taught four sections across two courses (40 students total): Philosophy of Mind: Puzzles vs. Mysteries I (1 section, 7 students); Introduction to Philosophy (3 sections, 33 students).
  - Encourage and facilitate critical self-reflection by facilitating dialogue. Facilitate meaningful learning through course outcomes, carefully constructed around historical questions of the philosophy of value and meaning, law, mind, aesthetics. I also develop curriculum and selected course materials that relies on emerging technologies encouraging media literacy and critical reflection on common assumptions.
  - Taught ~200 students using critical reflection on social narratives, common beliefs, and historical views.
  - Courses: Philosophy of Law, Introduction to philosophy: value, and meaning, philosophy of mind, aesthetics, introduction to logic.
  - Creatively use media narrative strategies (video games, dungeons and dragons) to encourage self-reflection and critical thinking, dialogue.

Philosophy Instructor (Adjunct) — Lewis and Clark Community College, Godfrey, IL *(2024–Present)*

- Taught 100+ students narrative ethics via media; 75% engagement rate
- Introduction to Ethics: Applied Ethics, Bioethics, Technology Ethics, Social Justice
- Designed narrative-based case studies and debates to enhance critical thinking

PhD Candidate / Instructor of Record — Saint Louis University, Saint Louis, MO *(2021–2024)*

- PHIL 2050: Ethics (Online/Asynchronous) — ethical theories, technology, and social justice
- PHIL 1700: The Examined Life: Ultimate Questions (2 sections/semester, 20–30 students each)
- Increased student engagement 10–15% through Socratic discussion and narrative-driven prompts

Graduate Teaching Assistant — Saint Louis University & Oklahoma State University *(2015–2018)*

- PHIL 1050: Introduction to Philosophy: Self and Reality
- Introduction to Ethics, Philosophy of Law
- Led 15+ discussion sections (25+ students each)

Research & Scholarship

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- Reynolds, M. (Forthcoming). *Social Identity and Music: A search for moral autonomy and personhood in pop culture.* Vernon Press.
- Reynolds, M. (Forthcoming). True Love's Agency: God, Moral Realism and the Affirmation of Personhood. In *Black Apologetics: Reflections on the Viability of Christian Faith.*
- Reynolds, M. (Forthcoming). Aesthetics of Epistemic Evil. In *Annihilating Evil.*
- Chakrabarty, U., Feiertag, R., McCallion, A.-M., McNiff, B., Prinz, J., Reynolds, M., et al. (2024). Adaptive Preferences: An Empirical Investigation of Feminist Perspectives. In *Experiments in Moral and Political Philosophy* (pp. 310–330). Routledge.

Some Works in Progress

- Bruised Soul: Virtual Works of Art inside the Space Sim Star Citizen.
- RealityCraft: Cultivating epistemic virtue with Embodied LLM Agents in Minecraft.
- Testifying: Ballet reconstruction and epistemic authenticity.

Conference Activity

Paper Presentations

- Reynolds, M. (2024). Emotional Datum: The Moral Expressions of Sentiment in Narratives. *American Society for Aesthetics, Rocky Mountain Division,* Santa Fe, NM.
- Reynolds, M. (2024). Comments on Aliya Dewey's "Rationalizing Behavior as Reasons Responsive." *Central APA Meeting,* New Orleans.
- Reynolds, M. (2023). Love and Wonder in Country Music: Objective not relative authenticity and value in country music. *American Society for Aesthetics, Rocky Mountain Division,* Santa Fe, NM.
- Reynolds, M. (2022). Getting Things Right in Country Music: An Account of Meaning in Country. *American Society for Aesthetics, General Meeting,* Montreal.
- Reynolds, M. (2022). Sensible Self-Censorship: TV Guide to Love and Friendship. *American Society of Aesthetics, Rocky Mountain Division,* Santa Fe, NM.
- Reynolds, M. (2019). Basically, You Are Justified: A knowledge first account of religious belief. *12th Annual LSU Graduate Philosophy Conference,* Baton Rouge, LA.

- Reynolds, M. (2018). Plantinga's Unique Naturalism as a Criticism of Evolutionary Reliabilism. *Great Lakes Philosophy Conference,* Sienna Heights University, Adrian, MI.
- Reynolds, M. (2017). Convenience and Correspondence: Plantinga's Unique Naturalism as a Criticism of Evolutionary Reliabilism. *ECST XVII,* Écully, France.
- Reynolds, M. (2017). The Evolution of Religious Belief. *The Evolution of Religion II,* Bernalillo, NM.

Invited Presentations & Webinars

- Reynolds, M. (2023). Sentiment Analysis, Hip-Hop and Country Comparison. Webinar, *Walter J. Ong Digital Humanities Center.*
- Reynolds, M. (2022). Introduction to Quanteda and Taylor Swift. *Feminist X-Phi Lab,* City University of New York.
- Reynolds, M. (2022). Aesthetic Blame, Robbie Kubal. Commentary, *American Society for Aesthetics, Pacific Division,* Berkeley, CA.

Workshops Attended

- Deep Learning for Humanists. University of Victoria, BC (Online), 2023.
- Towards a Feminist X-Phi & Empirical Philosophy Lab. CUNY Graduate Center, 2021–2023.
- CoLiPhi: Corpus Linguistics and Philosophy. University of Zurich, 2021.

Research Experience

- Graduate Research Fellow — Walter J. Ong Digital Humanities Center, Saint Louis University *(2022–2023)*
  - Built NLP pipelines for 10,000+ music lyrics, advancing multimedia research
  - Created Shiny dashboards for narrative trends, presented to 20+ stakeholders
  - Led online workshop on computational text analysis applying ethical frameworks
  - Trained 5 humanists in R and Quanteda for digital humanities research
- Feminist X-Phi Lab Research Collaborator — City University of New York *(2021–2023)*
  - Cross-cultural analysis of attitudes regarding attribution of agency across gender and social class
- Expert Contributor — Snorkel.ai, Remote *(2025–Present)*

  - Authored and validated original graduate-level problems to test LLM fluency and reasoning
  - Contributed to proprietary datasets used in AI fine-tuning, benchmarking, and reinforcement learning
  - Applied subject-matter expertise to identify reasoning flaws and refine model outputs

Other Professional Experience

- The Moral Imagination and Hope Laboratory — MIHLab.org, (2024-Present)
  - Design immersive online philosophical curriculum through game design.
- Director of Education — BGG Foundation (MMO Gaming Ethics), Saint Louis, MO (2025–2026)
  - Designed immersive online philosophy curriculum using Star Citizen and Discord
  - Engaged 50+ participants in virtual roleplay and ethical discussions
  - Applied narrative analysis to foster critical thinking; member, Saint Louis Digital Humanities Group
- Assistant to the Editor — Res Philosophica and Schutzian Research, Saint Louis, MO (2019–2023)
  - Pre-checked 4 journal editions/year (5–6 articles each) for style and consistency
  - Typeset submissions using LaTeX; liaised with proofreader
  - Developed ML tools to automate bibliographic structuring and citation management
  - Implemented NLP for metadata extraction and text classification
- Retail Sales and Trainer — T-Mobile, Oklahoma and Seattle (2010–2018)
  - Trained 15+ staff on sales and customer service, improving team performance 10%
  - Analyzed customer trends to optimize processes, developing data-driven insights
- U.S. Coast Guard, Active Duty (Aviation Machinist Technician) (1997–2000)
  - Served in high-pressure maritime operations; leadership and crisis management in dynamic team settings

Grants & Awards

- Graduate Fellow, Saint Louis University — $3,750 (2023)
- Graduate Education Award, Saint Louis University — $1,000 (2022, 2022)
- PhD Book Fund Award, Edward L. and Rhelda Marbry Morgan — $1,000 (2021)
- Philosophy Academic Enhancement Fund, Saint Louis University — multiple awards 2020–2023 (total ~$3,418)
- Graduate Student Association, Saint Louis University — $333 (2020), $300 (2022)
- Travel Scholarships & Philosophy Travel Awards, Saint Louis University — multiple awards 2019–2020

Skills & Training

Technical Skills

- **Programming:** R, Python
- **Infrastructure:** Git / GitHub
- **AI / NLP:** AI Model Evaluation & Reasoning Validation, Logical Error Detection, Data Annotation, LLM Prompt Engineering
- **Natural Languages:** English (native), French (basic), Spanish (basic), Latin (reading)

Professional Training

- Introduction to Agile Development & Scrum — IBM / Coursera (2025)
- Google Data Foundations: Data, Data Everywhere — Google / Coursera (2025)
- Deep Learning for Humanists — University of Victoria (2023)
- Natural Language Processing — Walter J. Ong Center Workshop (2022)
- Corpus Linguistics & Experimental Philosophy — Universität Zürich (2021)
- SQL Essential Training — LinkedIn Learning (2021)

Professional Memberships

- American Philosophical Association
- American Society of Aesthetics
- Saint Louis Digital Humanities Network